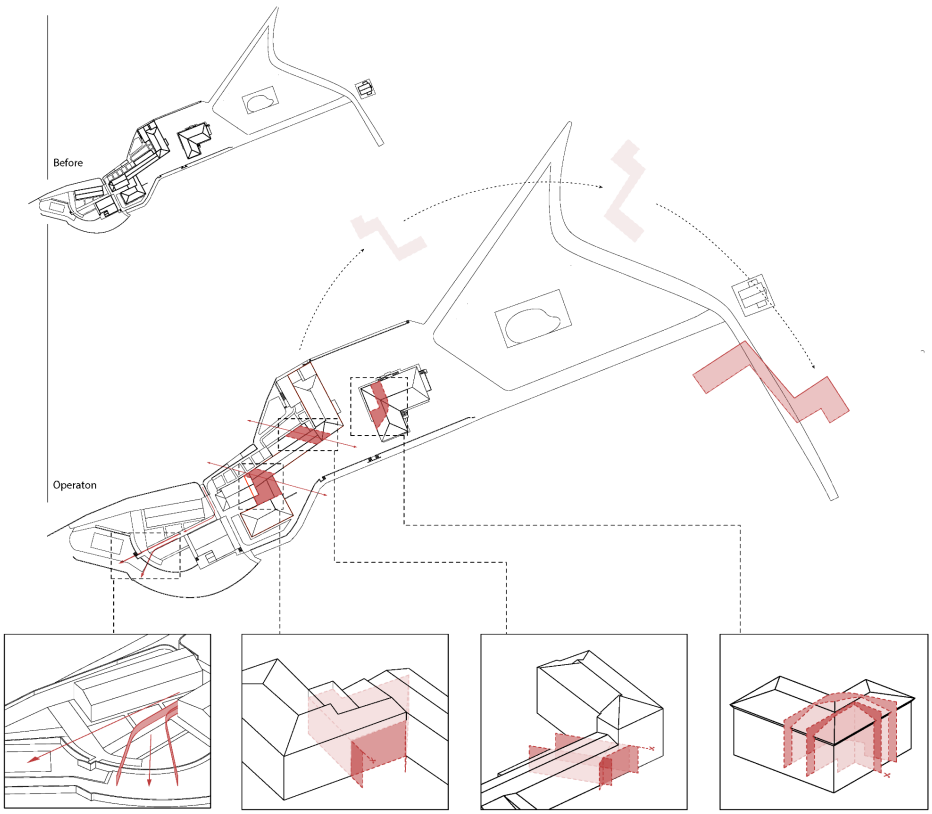
Cut/Connect

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Our site strategy proposal for the Karma Borgo di Colleoli is formulated to create opportunities and spaces of connection and proposes new possibilities for navigation throughout the Borgo. Each incision into any of the existing buildings is an attachment point for an interconnected web of new spatial continuity with which to experience and explore the Borgo, through engagement of the land and buildings themselves.
These cuts activate intersections between the accumulated buildings, threading natural courtyards, patios, passageways, and commons, through these selective spaces carved into the joints of the architecture on the site. In tandem, articulations of the ground itself guide wayfinding through and around these interventions and suggest new methods of circulation and exploration within each space. Each carve serves to bridge the commons of the Borgo into greater cohesion and connection to build on the charming and history-melding aura that is experienced in this landscape.



Our winery proposal sits at the south end of the site, acting as a sort of vine itself bridging the road and transporting visitors and guests through the winemaking process. The passageway over the road co-opts the ideal of the Corridoio Vasario and the Ponte Vecchio in nearby Florence, and provides an opportunity for activating and experiencing the sweeping, panoramic views afforded over the road. The bridge, acting the part of a natural billboard for the entire property, serves as a form of living gallery, one which invites guests and staff alike to pause and take in the sights and environment in order to be reminded of the beauty they are surrounded by.

The overall form of the winery reflects the Borgo, pinwheeling the shape created by the central accumulation of buildings onsite and bridging across the site to the church at the southern hillside portion of the property. The parking that exists at this spot would be moved just down the road to a permeably paved lot beyond the winery to improve both the experience of parking and accessing the hotel from the lot.

The north and south ends of the winery each take into account one half of the process of experiencing winemaking. The southern end of the building, acting as a root and sitting higher on the hill, comprises the pressing and aging of grapes. As it crosses the road, the northern branch nests into the landscape with spaces comprising the tasting and experience of the completed wine, overlooking the growing grapes as you enjoy the unique taste of the hills you sit among. The winery complex also adds several new suites directly into the heart of the vineyard hillside with picturesque views looking north back toward the skyline of the Borgo.



In both our winery proposal as well as in our cut-to-connect strategy for melding commons and passages onsite, we designed extensively around the mission of the Karma group and their desire to be more than just a hotel. Our goal was to create anew and showcase the beautiful architectural opportunities that could build upon the programmatic elements of staying at a Karma property, replete with unique and locally engaged events, adventures, and guided activities. To that end, each end of the site creates spaces for group gatherings and experiences through terracing portions of the ground and nestling amphitheaters within the landscape, and the architectural layouts throughout our designs encourage interaction with the experience of the sights, sounds, and beauty of the property itself, the church, and the surrounding countryside.